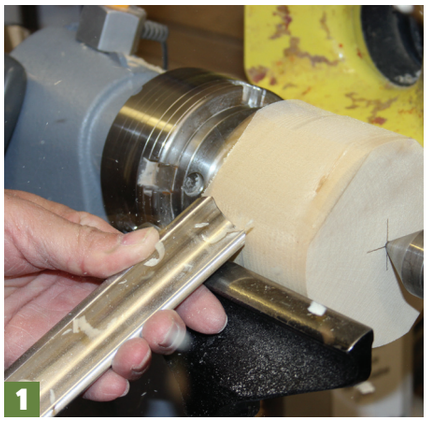
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1 Mount the bowl between centres, this is a spindle grain project where the grain is running parallel with the lathe bed, so this will be turned with spindle tools. Use a spindle roughing gouge to turn this to a cylinder, keeping the rest as close to the work as possible

2 You need a means of holding this in a chuck so you need to produce a spigot. On the end of the cylinder you can see a line; this is the diameter that you will part down to. Once you have reached this line, use the skew chisel to produce the dovetail to match your jaws

3 Use a spindle gouge to start the shaping process of the outside of the bowl. Try to always go from the large diameter to the small diameter to give the best finish, this means going from left to right and downwards towards the spigot

4 Leave a step at the base next to the spigot for added strength, although this would be more important with larger items. You are looking for a gentle curve with no flat spots on the curve. The base will be finished later after the inside is finished

5 Use the spindle gouge to clean the top face of the bowl. This means lining up the bevel with the top face on the outer edge and rubbing the bevel on the top surface as you move towards the centre of the face to leave a clean top face

6 Still using the spindle gouge, remove the waste from inside the bowl. Use the gouge with the flutes on their side and facing the direction of the cut, if the flutes face upwards it will be a very aggressive cut. Start in the centre and work towards the outer edge

7 As you can see I have removed a lot more waste from the top half. Don't go too deep at this point to reduce vibration when working near the top of the bowl. Aim for a wall thickness of 4mm in the top section. Reduce the depth of cut you take as the wall thickness thins

8 Use a round or French curve scraper to refine the top part, reduce the lathe speed for this part to avoid any vibration. Hold with the tool tip lower than the handle to give you a trailing mode on the cutting tip. Use a pair of callipers to check wall thickness with the lathe stopped

HANDY HINTS

1. Wear personal dust and eye protection when turning, especially if you're working with toxic timbers
2. Always keep your fingers and hand at your side of the toolrest

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